Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff Software Engineer | Product Engineering, AI & Commerce

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product-minded Staff Software Engineer experienced in commerce products, developer platforms, and messaging workflows. Brings judgment to ambiguous, cross-system problems: prototypes and evaluates feasible solutions, builds pragmatic abstractions, and collaborates across teams to carry them toward launch. Combines deep TypeScript/React expertise with hands-on applied AI engineering and a track record of technical leadership and mentorship.

CORE SKILLS

Product and engineering: Technical leadership, end-to-end product development, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, API architecture, checkout and messaging workflows, developer experience, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma

Applied AI: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, agent orchestration, model evaluation, multimodal generation, MCP, human-in-the-loop validation, provider fallbacks

Platform and operations: Docker, Kubernetes, asynchronous jobs, reliability patterns, cross-functional implementation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–November 2026

- Independently designed and iterated on an agent-based Liquid migration prototype for customized Shopify email templates. It reached about **90% success** on a small curated benchmark comprising five representative template types drawn from 17 templates and five merchant configurations.
- Established staged evaluation with parsing, before/after rendering, vision-model comparison, and human review. Served as technical lead for six engineers on production development; the initiative was canceled before launch and never shipped or migrated customers.
- Contributed across Shopify Bundles' merchant experience, checkout behavior, and first-party Admin application. Brought Shopify's UI extension pattern into the Admin product detail page and built the initial Bundles card; mentored junior developers and an intern.
- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, Shopify's internal AI media product, into a reusable TypeScript library with web, CLI, and MCP clients. It generated **100,000+ images**, with daily generation frequently exceeding 1,000 and sometimes 2,000. Designed model-capability metadata, asynchronous generation, provider failover, and video job polling.
- Built multi-agent developer productivity tools including specialized code review, summary/diagram generation, low-latency safety checks with human override, and extensible UI components for Pi IDE.
- Implemented coverage calculations and rule-inheritance visualizations for channel-specific merchant product data, in a product shipped as part of Shopify Editions in 2026; prototyped enhancements to the bulk editor.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | May 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped developer-facing APIs for sandboxed Checkout UI Extensions with a Principal Engineer. The underlying concepts carried forward into Shopify's production checkout extensibility platform.
- Worked on native B2B commerce capabilities including business customers and deferred payment terms following Shopify's acquisition of Handshake.
- Contributed to a first-party post-checkout upsell product; named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658, *Systems and methods for providing post-transaction offers* (2022).

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Worked across a small engineering organization on a multi-tenant wholesale commerce platform; contributed to the React replatforming, self-service ordering, and configurable B2B catalogs.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Developed major ecommerce checkout and cart experiences, shared frontend libraries, build and asset tooling, and responsive UI; mentored other engineers.

Earlier: Mindspark Interactive Networks, Web Developer (2008–2009); Tyler Technologies, Developer (2006–2008); UTA AI Lab, Research Assistant (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | B.S., Computer Science